

Νέσσος ὁ Χῖος

## Democritus's Teacher Nessos of Chios on Homeric Interpretation

eul\_aid: coo

**Period:** [Κλασική](#) Classical  
**Dialect:** [Ἰωνική](#) Ionic  
**Domain:** [Φιλοσοφία](#) Philosophy  
**Format:** [Συναγωγή](#) Collection  
**Affiliation:** [Presocratic](#)

Nessos of Chios was a philosopher who lived in Greece during the 5th century BCE, in the Classical period. He is identified as a Presocratic thinker, a group concerned with the fundamental nature of the world. His primary historical role was as a teacher of the much more famous philosopher Democritus.

No specific details about his life, background, or education survive. He is mentioned only in connection to his student. According to the ancient biographer Diogenes Laertius, Democritus once referred to Nessos with a cryptic term meaning "shore-fighter." The exact meaning is unclear, but some scholars suggest it might imply Nessos was a sophist or skilled in rhetorical debate.

No works written by Nessos himself are known to have survived, and no titles or contents are recorded in ancient sources. His entire significance comes from his association with Democritus, who would go on to develop the influential atomic theory of matter. This connection places Nessos within the network of early Greek natural philosophy, representing a link in the transmission of these ideas, even if his own contributions are lost to history.

### Works (2)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ὅμηρικῆς Ἑρμηνείας](#) · [Fragments on Homeric Interpretation](#) · 2 passages
- [Μαρτυρίαι](#) · [Testimonies](#) · 2 passages

### Other Presocratic Authors

- [Ἀλκμαίων ὁ Κροτωνιάτης](#) · [Alcmaeon of Croton](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀναξαγόρας ὁ Κλαζομένιος](#) · [Anaxagoras of Clazomenae](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀναξίμανδρος ὁ Μιλήσιος](#) · [Anaximander of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀναξίμενης ὁ Μιλήσιος](#) · [Anaximenes of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀναξιμένους τοῦ Μιλησίου Ἐπιστολαί \(Ψευδο-Ἀναξίμενης\)](#) · [Anaximenes-pseudo Miletus Letters](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρχέλαος ὁ Μιλήσιος ὁ Ἀθηναῖος](#) · [Archelaus of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- [Κλεόβουλος ὁ Λίνδιος](#) · [Cleobulus of Lindos I](#) · 1 work
- [Δημόκριτος ὁ Ἀβδηρίτης](#) · [Democritus of Abdera](#) · 2 works
- [Διογένης ὁ Ἀπολλωνιάτης](#) · [Diogenes of Apollonia](#) · 2 works

- Ἐμπεδοκλῆς ὁ Ἀκραγαντίνος · Empedocles of Acragas · 3 works
- Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Heraclitus of Ephesus · 2 works
- Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Heraclitus of Ephesus II · 1 work